30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

LEVEL 2

git init and Your First Commit

Week 1: First Steps | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 2 OF 30

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The Story: Opening a Save Slot

Commit the Cat sets up a brand-new project.

1

A plain folder

Right now Git is not watching this folder. No saves yet.

2

git init

Creates a hidden .git vault inside the folder. Run it once per project.

3

git add

Chooses which files go into the next save point.

4

git commit

Makes the save point and attaches a short message.

Your First Save: 4 Moves

Type these in order and watch what Git says back.

1 Make a folder

```
$ mkdir my-first-repo
$ cd my-first-repo
```

Create the project folder and step inside it.

GIT REPLIES:

```
(no output)
```

2 Start Git

```
$ git init -b main
```

Creates the hidden .git vault. Once per project.

GIT REPLIES:

```
Initialized empty
Git repository in
/.../my-first-repo/.git/
```

3 Pick the file

```
$ git add hello.txt
```

Chooses hello.txt for the next save.

GIT REPLIES:

```
(no output means
success)
```

4 Save it!

```
$ git commit -m "Add hello.txt"
```

Makes the save point with a message.

GIT REPLIES:

```
[main (root-commit) 3f2a9c1]
Add hello.txt
1 file changed
```

git status (before add)

```
On branch main
No commits yet
Untracked files:
        hello.txt
```

Untracked = Git can see the file, but you haven't asked it to save it yet.

git log --oneline (after commit)

```
3f2a9c1 (HEAD -> main) Add hello.txt
```

3f2a9c1 is the commit's ID. HEAD -> main means you are standing on this save point.

Remember: init once, then add and commit again and again.

Quest Board: Make Your First Repo

Finish 4 quests, then collect 3 commits as loot.

1 Create a project folder

```
$ mkdir my-first-repo
$ cd my-first-repo
```

2 Turn it into a repository

```
$ git init -b main
```

Look for: Initialized empty Git repository

3 Create a file and check status

```
$ echo "Hello, Git!" > hello.txt
$ git status
```

hello.txt should show up as untracked.

4 Add, commit and look back

```
$ git add hello.txt
$ git commit -m "Add hello.txt"
$ git log --oneline
```

LOOT: TODAY'S 3 COMMITS

COMMIT 1

day02-first-commit/README.md

```
docs(day02): add lesson on git init and first commit
```

The lesson with steps and cheat sheet.

COMMIT 2

day02-first-commit/demo.tape

```
feat(day02): add VHS tape for git init demo
```

Script that records the terminal GIF.

COMMIT 3

exercise.md + main README.md

```
chore(day02): add exercise and update progress tracker
```

Challenge, and the tracker moves to 2/30.

Now you can commit from your own terminal! Try creating these files locally, then git add and git commit each one.

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, fixes, quiz, and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 2 CHEAT SHEET

```
git init -b main     Create a repository here
git status           See what Git sees
git add <file>       Pick a file for the next save
git commit -m "msg" Make the save point
git log --oneline    List your save points
```

BONUS 2: COMMON PROBLEMS

```
not a git repository  -> cd into the project or run git init
Author identity unknown -> run the git config lines from Day 1
nothing to commit      -> edit a file, then git add it
```

BONUS 3: DIAGRAM GITHUB DRAWS FOR YOU

```
```mermaid
gitGraph
  commit id: "first commit"
```
```

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. Which command turns a folder into a Git repository?
2. What does 'untracked' mean in git status?
3. What is the hidden folder that stores your commits?

Answers: 1) git init 2) Git sees the file but you haven't added it 3) .git

CHALLENGE

Make a new repo with about-me.txt, commit it, edit the file, then commit again. git log --oneline should show 2 commits!

LEVEL 3: The 3 Areas of Git

Unlocks tomorrow. Learn where your files live before they become commits.

LOCKED